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Biodiversity *Pitch Deck Builder*

Turn conservation data, field findings, and project results into donor-ready, funder-ready, and partner-ready presentations — structured to persuade, not just inform.

BUILT FOR

Conservation NGOs

Field Researchers Seeking Funding

Graduate Students

Protected Area Managers

THE TRANSFORMATION

From "I have strong science and weak funding" to "I have a presentation that makes any funder, partner, or decision-maker understand why this conservation work matters and what it will take to succeed."

HOW TO USE THIS PRODUCT

Read Sections 1–3 once. Then go directly to the Slide-by-Slide Blueprint (Section 5) and use the AI Prompt Pack (Section 7) to draft your specific deck. The Before/After Library (Section 8) is the fastest way to improve a draft you already have.

Contents: Core Promise · Pain Points · Desired Outcomes · 4-Step Build System · Slide-by-Slide Blueprint (12 slides) · Audience Adaptation Guide · AI Prompt Pack · Before/After Language Library · 4 Full Deck Structures · Data Visualisation Guide · Delivery Notes · Quick Start

SECTION 1

The Core Promise

Conservation science is chronically underfunded not because the work is unimportant, but because the people doing the best work are rarely the people who are best at asking for money. A researcher who has spent three years documenting lemur population decline in a disappearing forest should not also have to become a professional fundraiser. But they do. And the quality of the pitch determines whether the next three years of research happen at all.

A pitch deck is not a report. It is not a paper. It is not a summary of your methods. It is a structured argument designed to move a specific person toward a specific decision — to fund the project, partner with you, change a policy, or tell your story to their audience. The science is the foundation. The deck is the bridge between the science and the decision.

THE TRANSFORMATION

Before: "I have strong science and no idea how to present it to people who control the money."

After: "I have a presentation that makes any funder, partner, or decision-maker understand why this work matters and what they need to do to support it."

What this system provides: A complete blueprint for building a conservation pitch deck — from slide structure and language frameworks to data visualisation choices, audience adaptation, AI prompts for every slide, and a library of before/after examples showing the difference between a scientist's first draft and a funder-ready presentation.

What this system does not do: Write your deck for you. It gives you the structure, the language, and the tools. The specific science, the honest data, and the genuine commitment to the mission — that is yours, and no template can replace it.

10 Real Pain Points

01 You present information instead of making an argument.

Scientific training teaches you to present data neutrally. Pitch decks require you to build a structured case toward a specific conclusion. These are different skills and they require different structures.

02 You cannot explain what your project does in one sentence.

If you need three slides to explain the problem and two more to describe the method before anyone understands what you are doing, you have lost most of your audience before the science begins.

03 Your slide deck is a document, not a presentation.

Dense text, small maps, long methodology sections, complex data tables — these belong in a report. A pitch deck is a visual argument. It is designed to be seen and heard simultaneously, not read.

04 You do not know what the funder or audience actually cares about.

A conservation donor, a government ministry, a scientific journal editor, and a community representative care about completely different things — even when looking at the same project. A pitch that does not adapt to the audience fails regardless of how good the science is.

05 Your data is accurate but unconvincing.

Raw numbers without context, maps without comparison, trend lines without explanation — these are data. A pitch deck needs insight. The difference between "we recorded 47 species" and "this site holds 23% of Madagascar's known herpetofauna in an area the size of 400 football pitches" is the difference between a data point and an argument.

06 You do not have a clear ask.

Many conservation presentations end without telling the audience what to do. "We hope for continued support" is not an ask. "We need \$45,000 to fund three field seasons producing the MRV-grade data required for biodiversity credit certification" is an ask.

07 You spend too long on methods and too little time on impact.

Funders and partners do not fund methods. They fund outcomes. The methodology earns credibility — it does not make the case for funding on its own.

08 You struggle to communicate urgency without exaggerating.

Overstating the crisis undermines scientific credibility. Understating it fails to motivate action. The framing of urgency is one of the most technically difficult parts of conservation communication — and this guide gives you a framework for it.

09 Your team and credentials are buried or absent.

Funders and partners do not give money to projects. They give money to people. The team slide is not a vanity section — it is where trust is built or lost.

10 You have no system for adapting one deck to multiple audiences.

Building a new deck from scratch for every funder, partner, or presentation context is unsustainable. This system gives you a modular structure you can adapt in under an hour.

10 Desired Outcomes

#	Outcome
01	State your project's core value in one sentence that any non-specialist can understand and remember.
02	Build a 12-slide pitch deck in under 4 hours using the provided blueprint.
03	Adapt the same deck for four different audience types — donor, government, scientific, community — without starting from scratch.
04	Present data in a way that creates insight, not just information.
05	Frame urgency accurately — compelling without exaggeration.
06	End every presentation with a specific, clear, and achievable ask.
07	Present your team in a way that builds trust and demonstrates credibility.
08	Respond confidently to the five hardest questions any conservation funder asks.
09	Use your pitch deck content as a foundation for grant application narratives.
10	Feel genuinely confident presenting this work to a high-stakes audience.

The 4-Step Deck Build System

1

DEFINE THE AUDIENCE AND THE ASK FIRST

Before you write a single slide, answer two questions. Everything else depends on them.

THE TWO QUESTIONS

Question 1 — Who is in the room? Are they a conservation donor who funds field projects? A government minister who manages protected areas? A scientific committee evaluating methodology? A community leader who lives adjacent to the site? Each requires a different deck. See the Audience Adaptation Guide (Section 6).

Question 2 — What specific action do you want them to take? Fund the project at a specific amount? Approve a permit? Partner on a data-sharing agreement? Attend a follow-up meeting? Name the single action. Your deck is structured backward from that action.

Rule: A deck designed for everyone is effective for no one. If you do not know who is in the room and what you want them to do, do not build the deck yet.

BUILD THE ARGUMENT STRUCTURE BEFORE THE SLIDES

A pitch deck is a structured argument with a beginning, middle, and end. Before you open any presentation software, sketch the argument on paper:

THE ARGUMENT SPINE

1. **The situation:** What is the current state of this ecosystem, species, or conservation issue?
2. **The problem:** What is wrong, missing, or at risk — and why does it matter?
3. **The opportunity:** What would become possible if this problem were addressed?
4. **The solution:** What specifically are you doing or proposing to do?
5. **The evidence:** What data, experience, or prior results prove this approach works?
6. **The ask:** What specifically do you need, and what will it produce?

If you cannot complete this spine in one paragraph, your argument is not ready for slides. Write the argument first. The slides visualise it.

BUILD SLIDES FROM THE BLUEPRINT

Use the Slide-by-Slide Blueprint in Section 5. Build one slide at a time. Each slide has one job. If a slide is trying to do two things, split it.

THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT SLIDE DESIGN RULE

Every slide has one headline — a complete sentence that states the single claim this slide is making. Not a topic ("Results") but a claim ("The northern forest patch holds the highest mammal diversity of all six survey sites"). If the audience reads only the headlines, they should understand the full argument.

TEST AND EDIT FOR AUDIENCE COMPREHENSION

Before presenting to a funder, present to a non-specialist friend or colleague who has no background in conservation. Ask them to tell you in their own words what the project does, why it matters, and what you need. If they cannot, the deck needs revision — not a better explanation from you, but a clearer deck.

- Each slide: under 30 words of text (not counting headlines and data labels).
- Each visual: understandable without the spoken explanation.
- The ask: stated once, clearly, on a dedicated slide, with a specific number.
- The total deck: 12 slides maximum for a 10–15 minute pitch. 20 slides maximum for a 30-minute detailed presentation.

Slide-by-Slide Blueprint — 12 Slides

The standard 12-slide conservation pitch deck. Every slide has one job. Every section below gives you: the slide's purpose, what to put on it, what not to put on it, and a worked example from a Madagascar conservation context.

SLIDE 01 OF 12

The Hook

PURPOSE

Make the audience care about the problem before they know anything about your project. Open with a specific, vivid, emotionally grounded fact — not a general statement about biodiversity loss.

Must include:

- One striking fact, image, or statistic that creates immediate relevance
- A question or tension that the rest of the deck will resolve

Do NOT include: your project name, your methodology, your team, your budget. That comes later. The hook is about the world, not about you.

WEAK HOOK

"Biodiversity loss is one of the most serious environmental challenges facing our planet today. Madagascar is one of the world's most biodiverse countries and faces significant threats."

STRONG HOOK

"In the last 30 years, Madagascar has lost more than 40% of its remaining forest cover. The species disappearing from those forests exist nowhere else on Earth. Most of them have never been formally described."

PURPOSE

Define the specific conservation problem you are addressing. Not all biodiversity loss — the specific threat at the specific place you are working. Make it concrete enough that the audience can visualise it.

Must include:

- The specific threat (deforestation rate, invasive species pressure, poaching, habitat fragmentation)
- The specific geography — a named site, region, or ecosystem
- What is lost if nothing changes — stated in plain terms
- One quantitative anchor (a rate, a percentage, a timeline)

Do NOT include: global statistics without local context. Do NOT start with "According to the IUCN..." — start with your site.

WEAK PROBLEM STATEMENT

"Deforestation is a major driver of species extinction globally. In Madagascar, habitat loss threatens numerous endemic species across multiple ecosystem types."

STRONG PROBLEM STATEMENT

"The Ihofa forest patch in Alaotra-Mangoro covers 12,000 hectares. At current agricultural encroachment rates, the buffer zone will be functionally fragmented within 8 years — isolating a population of Indri indri with no known connectivity to any other viable forest block."

PURPOSE

This is the most under-used slide in conservation decks. It answers: if this problem is so serious, why hasn't it been solved? The answer to this question is what makes your project necessary — and fundable.

Must include:

- What is currently missing: data, funding, method, political will, community engagement, or infrastructure
- Why existing approaches have not been sufficient
- The specific gap your project addresses

Do NOT criticise previous conservation actors by name. The gap is structural, not a failure of individuals.

WORKED EXAMPLE — THE GAP SLIDE

Three problems prevent effective protection of the Ihofa forest:

Conservation finance actors cannot invest in forest protection they cannot verify. Without a standardised, auditable biodiversity score, the Ihofa forest cannot access biodiversity credit markets or REDD+ instruments.

At current capacity, the entire forest can be surveyed once per year. Encroachment and population changes happen continuously.

These gaps are not failures of local conservation effort. They are infrastructure problems. ERIS is built to close them.

SLIDE 04 OF 12

The Solution — What You Are Doing

PURPOSE

Introduce your project or approach. One clear sentence per element. This is not a methodology section — it is a solution statement.

Must include:

- What your project does in one sentence (the elevator pitch)
- The two or three core activities that constitute the solution
- What specifically changes as a result

Do NOT include transect distances, sample sizes, statistical models, or software used. Those belong in the methodology appendix.

WEAK SOLUTION STATEMENT

"We will conduct multi-approach biodiversity surveys using line transect distance sampling, passive acoustic monitoring with AudioMoth units, camera trap arrays, and drone-based thermal surveys analysed using YOLO v8 object detection models."

STRONG SOLUTION STATEMENT

"We produce the first field-verified ecological integrity score for Ihofa Forest — combining on-ground biodiversity surveys with drone thermal mapping — in a format that conservation finance can directly use."

PURPOSE

Show why you believe this approach works. Prior results, peer-reviewed methods, conference presentations, pilot data, or comparison with established comparable projects. This slide builds credibility.

Must include:

- At least one concrete prior result: a number, a detection, a finding
- Any published work, conference presentation, or institutional recognition
- A brief comparison: "comparable approaches in similar ecosystems have shown X"

Do NOT include unpublished preliminary results as if they were confirmed findings. Be honest about what is proof of concept vs. validated method.

WORKED EXAMPLE — EVIDENCE SLIDE (ERIS / OPLURIX CONTEXT)

Thermal drone surveys (Mavic 3T) at Ihofa Forest detected 340% more mammal signatures per survey hour than simultaneous ground transects — presented at the International Primatological Society Congress, 2025.

Flowers et al. (2023), American Journal of Biological Anthropology — multi-method lemur behavioural data from Beza Mahafaly, co-authored by the project lead.

Pierre Castel Foundation Laureate 2025, via Techni-Drones Madagascar — recognising conservation technology innovation.

PURPOSE

Ground the work spatially. For any audience outside Madagascar (or your specific region), you must establish where the work happens and why this site matters. A map is almost always the best visual for this slide.

Must include:

- A clear map showing site location in regional context
- Three to five site facts that establish its conservation significance
- The protection status and any known threats

Do NOT include GPS coordinates or micro-site details. Use this slide to establish significance, not to provide navigation.

PURPOSE

Present your most compelling data in a form that creates insight. One chart, one map, or one key number — not a results table. The visual must be understandable without the spoken explanation. See the Data Visualisation Guide (Section 9).

Must include:

- One primary visual: the single most compelling piece of data you have
- A headline that states the conclusion ("Detection rate in disturbed habitat was 40% lower — but not because mammals were absent")
- One caveat or limitation — this builds credibility, not weakness

Do NOT include multiple charts on one slide. One visual, one claim. Do NOT present data without a conclusion — data without interpretation is information, not evidence.

PURPOSE

Show the future state. If this project is funded and succeeds, what specifically changes? For the species, the ecosystem, the community, and the field of conservation. This slide is where the emotional and logical case come together.

Must include:

- A specific, measurable outcome (not "improved conservation outcomes")
- Who benefits — and how
- The timeline to impact
- What this enables beyond the immediate project (the leverage)

Do NOT promise impact you cannot deliver. Do NOT use language like "will save" or "will protect" — use "enables," "provides the basis for," "creates the conditions for."

WORKED EXAMPLE — IMPACT SLIDE

First ERIS pilot score for Ihofa Forest — providing the first field-verified, auditable ecological integrity measure for this site.

Score enables Ihofa to be evaluated for biodiversity credit instruments — creating a potential recurring revenue stream for the forest's protection that does not depend on grant cycles.

The ERIS scoring methodology, openly published, is replicable by any conservation team in Madagascar — lowering the barrier to conservation finance access for the entire national protected area network.

SLIDE 09 OF 12

The Team — Who Will Make This Happen

PURPOSE

Build trust through credibility. Funders give money to people, not to projects. This slide must answer: why are you and your team the right people to execute this work?

Must include:

- Each key team member with name, role, and one specific qualification or achievement
- The institutional partnerships that provide infrastructure, legitimacy, or access
- Any specific field experience at this site or with these methods

Do NOT include CVs. One line per person, maximum. Do NOT list team members without stating why each one is necessary for this specific project.

SLIDE 10 OF 12

The Plan — Timeline and Milestones

PURPOSE

Show that you have thought through execution. A simple visual timeline with four to six milestones. This slide demonstrates operational seriousness and gives the funder checkpoints they can track against.

Must include:

- A timeline of no more than 24 months (beyond that, plans become speculative)
- Four to six named milestones with clear deliverables
- At least one funder-visible output milestone (a report, a public dataset, a published score)

Do NOT show a Gantt chart with 30 tasks. Do NOT present a timeline that begins only after funding is confirmed — show that planning is already underway.

PURPOSE

State the ask with clarity and justification. This slide should feel like the natural conclusion of everything before it — not a sudden pivot to a transaction. Round numbers are acceptable for a pitch deck; detailed line items belong in the appendix or the formal budget document.

Must include:

- Total amount requested — stated prominently
- Three to five budget categories with approximate amounts
- Any matched funding, in-kind contribution, or institutional co-investment
- Cost-per-output: "this enables X field-seasons of data collection producing Y outputs"

Do NOT hide the number. Do NOT be vague about what the money buys. Do NOT apologise for the cost — defend it.

WEAK BUDGET FRAMING

"We are requesting funding support to continue our important conservation work in Madagascar, subject to available budget allocations."

STRONG BUDGET FRAMING

"We are requesting £18,000 to fund the thermal sensor acquisition and two full survey seasons that will produce the first ERIS pilot score for Ihofa Forest. This is the specific instrument that makes conservation finance access possible for this site."

PURPOSE

One slide, one ask, one next step. The closing slide removes every remaining barrier to action. It tells the audience exactly what to do and makes it easy to do it.

Must include:

- The single specific ask stated once more, clearly
- The next step: "We would like to schedule a 30-minute call to discuss the detailed methodology" / "The grant application deadline is [date]" / "We are available to answer questions today"
- Contact information

Do NOT close with "Thank you for your attention." Do NOT restate the entire project summary. Do NOT ask multiple questions. One ask, one next step.

Audience Adaptation Guide

The same 12-slide structure adapts to four different audiences by changing the emphasis, the language, and the evidence hierarchy. You do not rebuild the deck — you reweight it.

The Four Audiences

Audience	What they care about most	What builds trust	What loses them
Conservation Donor	Impact per dollar. Species, ecosystems, or communities protected. Clear evidence that their money will change something specific.	Field photos and video. Specific species. Honest acknowledgment of what will not be achieved.	Dense methodology. Jargon. Vague impact claims. Budgets without clear outputs.
Scientific Committee	Methodological rigour. Data quality. Reproducibility. Contribution to knowledge.	Published work. Comparison to established methods. Honest treatment of limitations.	Overclaimed results. Missing controls. Vague sampling design. Ignoring prior literature.
Government / Policy	National interest. Regulatory compliance. Economic benefit. International reporting obligations (CBD, IPBES, REDD+).	Alignment with national biodiversity strategy. Institutional partnerships. Clear handover of data to government systems.	International comparisons that imply domestic failure. NGO-centric framing. Anything that looks like foreign oversight.
Community Leaders	What changes for their community. Who benefits and how. Who controls the data and the process.	Local team involvement. Respect for traditional knowledge. Clear benefit-sharing mechanisms.	External-expert framing. Lack of local team visibility. Data collection without reciprocal information sharing.

Slide Emphasis by Audience

These are the slides to expand, shorten, or restructure when adapting the deck. Everything else stays the same.

Slide	Donor	Scientific	Government	Community
Hook	Lead with species, image, story	Lead with knowledge gap	Lead with policy context	Lead with local experience
Problem	Emotional + quantitative	Literature-grounded	Policy-framed	Locally lived
Gap	Emphasise funding gap	Emphasise methods gap	Emphasise data gap for reporting	Emphasise community exclusion
Evidence	Photos, results, recognition	Publications, methods papers	Compliance with national standards	Community engagement record
Impact	Species protected, hectares secured	Papers, datasets, open methods	CBD indicators, reporting outputs	Livelihoods, local capacity
Team	Lead with field experience	Lead with publications	Lead with institutional affiliation	Lead with local team members
Budget	Cost per outcome	Per-sample cost, efficiency	Alignment with national funding	Community employment component

AI Prompt Pack — 12 Prompts

One prompt per slide plus four additional prompts for common pitch challenges. Paste your project details after each prompt. Review and edit all output — you are responsible for accuracy.

Prompt 1 — Hook Slide

Write a hook slide opening for a conservation pitch deck. Context: - Species or ecosystem: [describe] - Primary threat: [describe] - Geographic location: [site and country] - Audience: [donor / scientific / government / community] Requirements: - One striking, specific, memorable fact or statement – maximum 2 sentences - The fact must be verifiable and accurate - It should create emotional and intellectual engagement simultaneously - Do NOT start with "Biodiversity loss is..." or any generic framing - Do NOT introduce the project yet Generate 3 alternative hook options and rate each for emotional impact and factual specificity.

Prompt 2 — Problem Statement Slide

Write a problem statement for slide 2 of a conservation pitch deck. Project context: - Site: [name and location] - Primary conservation problem: [describe specifically] - Key threat metric: [deforestation rate / species decline rate / habitat area] - Time horizon: [by when does action need to happen?] - Audience: [donor / scientific / government / community] Requirements: - Maximum 3 sentences - Must include one quantitative anchor - Must name the specific consequence of inaction - Frame for the specified audience - Avoid global statistics – root everything in the specific site

Prompt 3 — Gap Slide

Write the "gap" slide for a conservation pitch deck – explaining why this problem has not been solved already. Project context: - The conservation problem: [describe] - Current approaches being used: [what currently exists] - What is specifically missing: [data / funding / method / infrastructure / political will] - How your project addresses this gap: [one sentence] Requirements: - Identify 2–3 specific structural gaps (not personal failures) - Do not criticise any named organisation or individual - Make the gap feel both real and solvable - The gap slide should make your project feel necessary, not just useful

Prompt 4 — Solution Slide

Write a one-sentence project description and a 3-point solution summary for a conservation pitch deck. Project details: - What your project does (full description): [describe] - Target outputs: [list] - Target audience for this deck: [donor / scientific / government / community] Requirements: - The one-sentence description must be understandable by a non-specialist - It must state what you do, where, and to what end – no jargon - The 3-point summary should name the core activities in plain language - Do NOT include methodology, statistics, or software names

Prompt 5 — Evidence Slide

Write the evidence slide for a conservation pitch deck. Available evidence: - Prior field results: [describe any data or findings you have] - Publications or conference presentations: [list] - Institutional recognition or awards: [list] - Comparable projects with known results: [describe] Requirements: - Present evidence in order of credibility for the specified audience: [donor / scientific / government] - For each piece of evidence, state what it proves about the approach – not just that it exists - Be honest about whether results are confirmed, peer-reviewed, or proof-of-concept - Maximum 4 evidence points

Prompt 6 — Impact Slide

Write the impact section for a conservation pitch deck. Project context: - What specifically changes if this project succeeds: [describe] - Who benefits and how: [species, ecosystem, community, scientific field] - Timeline to measurable impact: [months or years] - What this enables beyond the immediate project: [leverage or downstream effects] - Audience: [donor / scientific / government / community] Requirements: - Frame impact in terms the specified audience values (see audience guide) - Use specific, measurable language – not "improved conservation outcomes" - Use qualified language: "enables," "provides the foundation for," "creates the conditions for" - Include a Year 1, Year 2, Year 3+ progression

Prompt 7 — Team Slide

Write a team slide for a conservation pitch deck. Team details: - Team lead: [name, role, most relevant qualification or achievement – 1 sentence each] - Key team members: [repeat format] - Institutional partners: [name and role] - Local team or community partners: [name and role] - Audience: [donor / scientific / government / community] Requirements: - One sentence per person maximum - Each sentence must state a specific qualification or achievement – not a job title alone - For community audiences, lead with local team members - Do NOT include CVs or publication lists - Make it clear why this specific team is uniquely positioned for this specific project

Prompt 8 — Budget Slide

Write a budget slide for a conservation pitch deck. Budget details: - Total amount requested: [amount and currency] - Funder: [name of grant programme or donor] - Budget categories and amounts: [list] - Any matched funding or in-kind contribution: [describe] - Expected outputs this budget enables: [list] Requirements: - State the total prominently – do not bury it - Provide 3–5 budget categories with approximate amounts - Include a "cost per output" frame: e.g., "This funds 3 full survey seasons producing..." - Frame the ask as an investment with a return – not a request for charity - Maximum 100 words

Prompt 9 — Five Hardest Funder Questions — Preparation

I am preparing to pitch a conservation project to [donor name / grant programme]. Project summary: [describe your project in 2–3 sentences] Generate: 1. The 5 hardest questions this specific funder is likely to ask 2. For each question: a concise, honest, and confident answer (2–4 sentences) 3. Any question I should raise proactively before being asked – because raising it myself builds more trust than waiting to be challenged Focus on questions about: methodology rigour, budget justification, impact measurement, timeline feasibility, and what happens if funding ends.

Prompt 10 — Urgency Framing (Honest)

Help me frame the urgency of this conservation problem accurately – compelling without exaggerating. The conservation issue: [describe the problem and timeline] Available evidence for urgency: [cite data or trends you have] Risk of overstating: [what would be scientifically irresponsible to claim?] Audience: [donor / scientific / government / community] Requirements: - Frame urgency in terms of irreversibility, not just severity - Use qualified language where uncertainty exists ("current trends suggest," "without intervention, projections indicate") - Identify the specific tipping point or threshold that creates genuine urgency - Do NOT use language that cannot be defended in a scientific context - Maximum 3 sentences for the urgency statement

Prompt 11 — One-Sentence Project Description

Write 5 alternative one-sentence descriptions of my conservation project for different audiences. Project details: [describe what you do, where, and what it produces] Generate one version for each audience: 1. Conservation donor (lead with impact and species) 2. Scientific committee (lead with method and contribution to knowledge) 3. Government ministry (lead with policy relevance and national benefit) 4. Community leader (lead with local benefit and community involvement) 5. General public (lead with the simplest, most vivid description possible) Each sentence: maximum 25 words. No jargon.

Prompt 12 — French Deck Adaptation

Translate and adapt the following pitch deck slide content into French for a Francophone donor or government audience. Audience: [Francophone donor / Madagascar government ministry / West African NGO partner] Requirements: - Natural French, not literal translation - Conservation and scientific terminology in standard French usage - Adapt any cultural framing for a Francophone institutional context - Do not translate species names (Latin) or project proper nouns - Maintain the same level of formality as the original Slides to translate: [PASTE YOUR SLIDE CONTENT HERE]

Before / After Language Library

20 specific language transformations from weak conservation pitch language to strong conservation pitch language. Study these and apply the same logic to your own deck.

Problem Framing

WEAK

"Madagascar is experiencing significant biodiversity loss due to deforestation and other anthropogenic pressures."

STRONG

"At current deforestation rates, the primary forest patch connecting the Ihofa and Angavo blocks will fragment completely before 2032 — eliminating the only viable dispersal corridor for three Critically Endangered lemur species."

WEAK

"This forest is home to many important endemic species."

STRONG

"Our 2024–2025 inventory documented 47 vertebrate species in this 12,000-hectare forest, of which 38 are endemic to Madagascar and 6 are classified as Critically Endangered."

Gap Framing

WEAK

"There is a lack of sufficient data to fully understand the conservation needs of this area."

STRONG

"Conservation finance instruments cannot currently value this forest because no credible, verifiable ecological score exists for it. Without that infrastructure, donor investment and biodiversity credit access are both impossible."

Solution Framing

WEAK

"We will conduct a comprehensive multi-method biodiversity survey using state-of-the-art technology."

STRONG

"We produce the first independently verifiable ecological integrity score for Ihofa Forest — the specific data product that unlocks conservation finance for this site."

WEAK

"Our innovative approach combines multiple methods for a holistic understanding of biodiversity."

STRONG

"Ground surveys, drone thermal mapping, and acoustic monitoring run simultaneously — each capturing what the others miss. Together, they produce a more complete species inventory than any single method alone."

Evidence Framing

WEAK

"Our team has extensive field experience and a proven track record."

STRONG

"The project lead has conducted field research at six Malagasy sites with four international institutions, co-authored a peer-reviewed paper on lemur feeding ecology, and presented drone survey methodology at IPS 2025."

WEAK

"Preliminary results are promising and suggest our approach is effective."

STRONG

"Thermal drone surveys at Ihofa detected 340% more mammal signatures per survey hour than concurrent ground transects — establishing proof-of-concept for the methodology at this specific site type."

Impact Framing

WEAK

"This project will contribute to the conservation of Madagascar's unique biodiversity and support sustainable development goals."

STRONG

"By Year 3, Ihofa Forest will have a field-verified ecological score, a published open methodology replicable by any Malagasy conservation team, and a pathway to biodiversity credit certification that does not depend on grant cycles."

Budget and Ask Framing

WEAK

"We are humbly requesting financial support to continue this vital work."

STRONG

"We are requesting £18,000 — which funds the thermal sensor acquisition and two survey seasons that produce the ERIS pilot score. This is the specific investment that makes everything downstream possible."

WEAK

"Any amount of funding would be greatly appreciated."

STRONG

"The full project requires £18,000. At £12,000, we complete one survey season and the scoring framework. At £18,000, we complete two seasons and deliver a validated pilot score ready for conservation finance submission."

Urgency Without Exaggeration

WEAK / OVERCLAIMED

"Every day we delay, species are going extinct forever. We are in a climate emergency and the window for action is closing rapidly."

HONEST URGENCY

"The habitat connectivity that makes this population viable will be broken by 2032 at current rates. That threshold is irreversible. The survey data we need to intervene takes two full field seasons to produce — which is why we are asking for funding now."

Data Visualisation Guide

Conservation data is often spatially complex, temporally distributed, and multivariate. These guidelines help you choose the right visual for each type of finding — and avoid the most common visualisation errors.

Choosing the Right Visual

FOR SPECIES PRESENCE / BIODIVERSITY RICHNESS

Best choice: Site map with bubble size = species count. Shows spatial distribution of richness intuitively. Immediately comparable across sites.

Use when: comparing multiple survey sites. Avoid when: fewer than 3 sites — a table is clearer.

FOR HABITAT LOSS OR CHANGE OVER TIME

Best choice: Side-by-side satellite image comparison (Year X vs. Year Y) with a simple area metric.

"Seeing" the change is more persuasive than any chart. Add one number: the percentage or absolute area change.

Use when: habitat change is your primary evidence of threat. Avoid when: imagery quality is poor or the change is not visually obvious.

FOR DETECTION RATE COMPARISON BETWEEN METHODS OR SITES

Best choice: Horizontal bar chart. Simple, fast to read, easy to label. Vertical bar charts work equally well. Avoid 3D bars — they distort relative height.

Use when: the comparison between 2–6 items is the primary message. Add error bars if you have them — it builds scientific credibility.

FOR POPULATION TREND OVER TIME

Best choice: Line chart with a single trend line and a shaded confidence interval. Shows direction and uncertainty. Annotate the key events (survey year, intervention, policy change).

Use when: you have 4+ time points. With fewer than 4 points, a simple table is more honest than a trend line.

FOR THERMAL DRONE SURVEY RESULTS

Best choice: Side-by-side comparison of thermal and RGB imagery at the same location. Shows what the technology reveals that standard photography cannot. Add count/detection annotations directly on the image.

Use when: demonstrating the value of the thermal method to a non-specialist audience. Always include a scale bar and a brief caption explaining what the colour gradient means.

FOR CONSERVATION FINANCE / BIODIVERSITY SCORE

Best choice: A simple composite score gauge or a colour-coded 5-indicator dashboard. Familiar to finance audiences. Immediately communicates overall status and component breakdown.

Use when: pitching to conservation finance, MRV, or REDD+ audiences. Always explain how the score is calculated — in one sentence on the slide.

Five Universal Visualisation Rules

- **One chart, one claim.** The headline of the slide states the claim. The chart proves it. Never combine two claims in one visual.
- **Remove everything that is not data.** No 3D effects, no gradient backgrounds, no decorative borders. Every visual element must carry information or support clarity.
- **Label directly.** Labels on bars and lines are clearer than legends. If the audience has to look back and forth between a legend and the chart, the visual has failed.
- **Show uncertainty honestly.** Error bars, confidence intervals, and explicit sample sizes make you look more rigorous, not less. Scientific audiences trust results more when uncertainty is shown.
- **Use colour with purpose.** One colour for the main finding. Grey for context. Red for threat or danger. Green for positive outcome. No rainbow colour schemes — they confuse the eye and the message.

Four Full Deck Structures

The same 12-slide framework adapted for four specific pitch contexts. Each structure shows which slides to expand, compress, or reframe.

Structure A — Rufford / Small Grant Application Pitch (12 slides, 10 min)

Slide	Content focus	Length
1 — Hook	Specific endangered species at the specific site. Photo if possible.	30 sec
2 — Problem	Habitat loss rate + timeline to irreversible threshold.	45 sec
3 — Gap	What data/infrastructure is missing for effective protection.	30 sec
4 — Solution	One-sentence project description. Three core activities.	60 sec
5 — Evidence	IPS Congress + publication + Pierre Castel. Proof of concept data.	45 sec
6 — Site	Map of Madagascar. Ihofa location. Protection status. Key species.	30 sec
7 — Data	One finding from the 2024–2025 survey. One chart. One headline.	45 sec
8 — Impact	Year 1: pilot score. Year 2: conservation finance pathway. Year 3: open methodology.	45 sec
9 — Team	Haja + Techni-Drones + institutional partner. One sentence each.	30 sec
10 — Plan	6-milestone timeline. Survey Season 1 → Score Delivered → Published.	30 sec
11 — Budget	£18,000 total. 3 categories. Cost per output.	30 sec
12 — Ask	"We are applying for the Rufford Small Grant. Here is the application deadline and contact."	30 sec

Structure B — NGO Partnership Pitch (12 slides, 20 min)

Slide	Content focus	Notes
1 — Hook	The shared challenge — what both organisations care about	Establish common ground before introducing your project
2–3 — Problem + Gap	What the partner organisation's existing work is missing	Frame the gap as an opportunity for the partnership, not a failure
4 — Solution	How your project complements (not competes with) their work	Emphasise the additive value — what they gain that they do not currently have
5 — Evidence	Your track record + the partner's track record combined	Position the partnership as stronger than either alone
6–7 — Site + Data	Show where the partnership would operate and what data exists	If the partner already works in your area, use their data too
8 — Impact	What the partnership achieves that neither could alone	The leverage from combining your capability and theirs
9 — Team	Include both teams — show the combined capacity	Demonstrate that roles are complementary, not duplicated
10–11 — Plan + Budget	Shared milestones. Cost-sharing or in-kind contribution framework.	Be explicit about who does what and who funds what
12 — Ask	"We are proposing a data-sharing agreement / joint survey design / co-application to [funder]."	Specific, concrete, achievable next step

Structure C — Government / Protected Area Authority (10 slides, 15 min)

Slide	Content focus
1 — Hook	National biodiversity context. CBD Kunming-Montreal targets. Madagascar's commitments.
2 — Problem	Specific site under threat. Regulatory framing: what should be protected, is not effectively protected.
3 — Gap	What data the ministry needs to fulfil its reporting obligations that currently does not exist.
4 — Solution	How this project produces the specific data infrastructure that enables better protection decisions.
5 — Evidence	Peer-reviewed methods. Institutional partnerships. Alignment with national standards.
6 — Site + Data	Map in national context. Existing protection status. Known threats.
7 — Impact	CBD indicator alignment. REDD+ reporting potential. National biodiversity database contribution.
8 — Team	Institutional affiliation first. National credentials. Local team.
9 — Plan	Survey timeline aligned with reporting cycles. Data handover to government system.
10 — Ask	Permit approval. Access authorisation. In-kind institutional support. Data-sharing agreement.

Structure D — Conference Scientific Presentation (15 slides, 15 min)

Slide	Content focus
1 — Hook	The knowledge gap. What the field does not currently know or cannot currently measure.
2 — Study site	Site significance in the scientific literature. Prior surveys at this site if any.
3 — Research question	Stated as a question. Specific, measurable, answerable with the data collected.
4 — Methods overview	This is where the methodology gets its full slide — for scientific audiences only.
5–8 — Results (4 slides)	One finding per slide. Each with headline, visual, and explicit caveat.
9 — Interpretation	What the results mean for the research question.
10 — Limitations	Explicit treatment of what the study cannot claim. Builds credibility.
11 — Contribution to field	How this advances knowledge. What prior work it confirms, contradicts, or extends.
12 — Future work	The next logical research question. The ERIS scaling pathway.
13–14 — Acknowledgements + references	Funders, institutional partners, field team.
15 — Contact + data access	Where the data and methodology will be published. How to contact for collaboration.

Quick Start — Build Your Deck in 4 Hours

Hour 1 — Foundation

- ☐ Answer the two questions from Step 1: Who is in the room? What specific action do you want?
- ☐ Write the argument spine from Step 2 — all 6 points, one paragraph total.
- ☐ Choose your deck structure from Section 10 that best fits your context.
- ☐ Use Prompt 11 to write your one-sentence project description for this specific audience.

Hour 2 — Slides 1–6

- ☐ Hook slide: Use Prompt 1. Choose the strongest of the 3 options generated. Edit for accuracy.
- ☐ Problem slide: Use Prompt 2. Verify the quantitative anchor against your data.
- ☐ Gap slide: Use Prompt 3. Make sure the gap leads naturally to your solution.
- ☐ Solution slide: Use Prompt 4. Test it on a non-specialist — can they explain it back to you?
- ☐ Evidence slide: Use Prompt 5. List your evidence honestly. Do not overclaim.
- ☐ Site slide: Write your own — no AI needed. A map + 5 bullet points.

Hour 3 — Slides 7–12

- ☐ Data slide: Choose one finding. Choose the right visual from Section 9. Write the headline first.
- ☐ Impact slide: Use Prompt 6. Year 1 / Year 2 / Year 3+ structure.
- ☐ Team slide: Use Prompt 7. One sentence per person. Verify all details.
- ☐ Plan slide: Draw the timeline manually. 4–6 milestones, maximum 24 months.
- ☐ Budget slide: Use Prompt 8. State the number prominently. Cost-per-output frame.
- ☐ Close slide: One sentence. One ask. One next step. Contact details.

Hour 4 — Test and Edit

- ☐ Read every headline in sequence. Does the argument flow without the slides?
- ☐ Count words on each slide body. Remove everything above 30 words per slide.
- ☐ Run the Before/After check: find any language from the "weak" column in Section 8 and replace it.
- ☐ Present to one non-specialist. Ask them: what does the project do, why does it matter, what do you need? If they cannot answer: revise.
- ☐ Prepare answers to the 5 hard questions using Prompt 9.
- ☐ If adapting for French: run Prompt 12 on the complete slide text.

Minimum Viable vs. Premium Version

Feature	This Version (MVP)	Premium (Future)
4-step build system	✓	✓
12-slide blueprint with examples	✓	✓ Expanded to 20 slides
Audience adaptation guide (4 audiences)	✓	✓ 6 audiences
12 AI prompts	✓	✓ 20 prompts
Before/After language library (20 pairs)	✓	✓ 40 pairs
4 full deck structures	✓	✓ 8 structures
Data visualisation guide	✓	✓ With worked examples
PowerPoint / Google Slides master template	—	Planned
Slide-by-slide example deck (ERIS/OPLURIX)	—	Planned
Funder-specific adaptation guides (Rufford, WWF, GEF)	—	Planned
French version (full translation)	—	Planned
Delivery coaching guide (body language, Q&A)	—	Planned

Good science without a compelling argument *is just well-kept notes.*

The pitch deck is not a concession to the market. It is the bridge between the work you do and the resources it needs to continue. Building that bridge is part of the conservation mission — not a distraction from it.

Biodiversity Pitch Deck Builder v1.0

An OPLURIX Product · 2026

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